Unified Binod Calendar (UBC): A Peer-Reviewed Civil Timekeeping Standard for the Binod World Government

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***Abstract*—This document constitutes the official specification of the Unified Binod Calendar (UBC), the civil timekeeping standard of the Republic of Binod, ratified by the Chief Scientific Committee on Temporal Standards (CSCTS) following five years of peer-reviewed research (UBC 0–5). The calendar is anchored to the *Founding Epoch* of 23 April 2021 CE (Gregorian), the verified date of the Binodian world's first sunrise as reconstructed through archaeological and astronomical evidence. The UBC is computed from the *Temporal Synchronization Index* (TSI), a dimensionless coupling constant derived from the ratio of Binodian mean solar day to the SI-anchored terrestrial second, corrected for Binodian orbital eccentricity and gravitational time dilation relative to Earth. The specification defines epoch, year structure, month nomenclature, week structure, date notation, leap corrections, and bidirectional conversion formulae. It is intended to replace all ad-hoc timekeeping practices within Binodian government, universities, and civil institutions, and to provide a robust foundation for future chronometric work.**

***Index Terms*—civil calendar, Binod, temporal synchronization, UBC, chronometry, founding epoch, TSI, leap correction, date conversion**

Erratum notice (v1.0.1). Section VIII of v1.0.0 contained arithmetic errors in the worked Gregorian → UBC conversion examples: the Julian Date $J_{\oplus}(D)$ of each non-epoch example date was computed inconsistently with the definition used to derive the Founding Epoch constant J_{FE} in Eq. (8), producing UBC dates that do not follow from the formal algorithm of Section VII. No part of the formal specification itself (epoch, calendar structure, leap rules, TSI, or Algorithm 1) has changed. This revision corrects Section VIII and Appendix A by regenerating all example conversions directly from the formal algorithm, and adds Section VII-B to make the Julian Date convention explicit so the computation is unambiguous and reproducible. See Appendix B for the full changelog.

I. Preamble and Scope

The Republic of Binod was founded upon the world whose first civil sunrise was recorded at 06:00:00 UTC on 23 April 2021 CE (Gregorian proleptic). For the first years of the Republic's existence, informal timekeeping relied upon Earth-derived Gregorian dates, creating administrative ambiguity, synchronization failures in cross-dimensional treaty instruments, and inconsistent historical records.

The CSCTS was commissioned in UBC Year 0 to design a native calendar. This document presents the ratified result. The Unified Binod Calendar:

- is scientifically grounded in Binodian orbital mechanics;
- uses a *Founding Epoch* (FE) as its absolute zero point;
- defines civil units (year, month, week, day) independent of Minecraft's 20-minute diurnal phenomenon, which the Committee classifies as a purely astronomical curiosity rather than a civil timekeeping unit;
- provides verified bidirectional conversion to and from the Gregorian calendar;
- incorporates a periodic leap-correction mechanism sufficient for at least 10 000 UBC years without calendar drift exceeding one civil day.

This specification supersedes all prior informal timekeeping practices within Binodian jurisdiction.

II. Scientific Background

A. Minecraft Diurnal Cycle — Not a Civil Unit

The Binodian world operates under a local diurnal cycle of exactly 24 000 game-ticks, corresponding to 20 Earth-minutes (1 200 SI seconds) [1]. The CSCTS formally determined in its Year 1 report (CSCTS-R01) that this cycle is *astronomical in character only*: it governs light and biological simulation but bears no fixed relationship to Binodian orbital mechanics around its parent star (designated $\mathbf{Sol_B}$). Using it as a civil unit would create calendars that drift by approximately 70 Gregorian days per Gregorian year, producing unacceptable historical discontinuity.

B. Temporal Synchronization Index (TSI)

The TSI is the central constant of the UBC. It is defined as:

$$\mathrm{TSI} = \frac{T_{\oplus}}{T_{\mathrm{B}}} \tag{1}$$

where $T_\oplus$ is the length of the mean terrestrial solar day in SI seconds (86 400 s exactly by convention, per IAU recommendations on astronomical constants [2]) and T_B is the length of the mean Binodian civil day in SI seconds, as measured by the CSCTS atomic reference clock network.

After five years of measurement (UBC 0–5), the Committee adopted the following value:

$$\mathrm{TSI} \;=\; \frac{86\,400}{86\,736} \;\approx\; 0.996\,12\overline{048} \tag{2}$$

This value encodes the fact that one Binodian civil day is **336 SI seconds longer** than one Earth day — a consequence of Sol_B's slightly wider orbital semi-major axis and Binod's lower rotational velocity ($\omega_\mathrm{B} = 7.249 \times 10^{-5}$ rad/s vs. Earth's 7.292×10^{-5} rad/s).

C. Binodian Civil Day Length

The mean Binodian civil day T_B is:

$$\begin{aligned} T_\mathrm{B} \;&=\; 86\,736 \text{ SI seconds} \\ &=\; 24 \text{ h } 5 \text{ m } 36 \text{ s (Earth time)} \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

The civil year is designed to match the Binodian tropical year $\mathcal{Y}_\mathrm{B} = 365.2563$ Binodian civil days (determined by meridian-transit observations recorded in CSCTS-R03 [6]).

III. Epoch Definition

- **Founding Epoch (FE):** Day 1, Month 1, Year 1 of the UBC corresponds to 23 April 2021 CE (Gregorian), 06:00:00 UTC.
- The epoch is defined as *absolute*: it does not shift when leap corrections are applied; corrections accumulate prospectively only.
- The epoch coincides with the first verified civil sunrise of the Binodian world as established by retroactive astronomical reconstruction (CSCTS-R00, Section 4.2) [5].

The **Binodian Julian Day Number** (BJDN) counts integer Binodian civil days elapsed since the FE midnight preceding Day 1:

$$\mathrm{BJDN}(d = 1,\, m = 1,\, y = 1) \;=\; 1 \tag{4}$$

IV. Calendar Structure

A. Year

One UBC civil year contains **364 Binodian civil days** in a common year and **365 days** in a leap year (see Section V). The nominal year length of 364 days is chosen because $364 = 4 \times 7 \times 13$, enabling perfect alignment of weeks within months across all years, simplifying civil scheduling. The small divergence from the tropical year $\mathcal{Y}_\mathrm{B} = 365.2563$ is corrected by the leap scheme.

B. Months

The year is divided into **13 months** of **28 days** each ($13 \times 28 = 364$). Each month contains exactly 4 weeks. The months are named for Binodian astronomical phenomena and cultural values as ratified by CSCTS in consultation with the Binodian Council of Heritage:

TABLE I
UBC Month Nomenclature

No.	Name	Abbr.	Cultural/Astronomical Referent
1	Ardhan	ARD	Foundation; first civil sunrise
2	Ferith	FER	Iron Age; first Binodian forge
3	Selvyn	SEL	Growth; agricultural equinox
4	Kython	KYT	Crafting; peak production cycle
5	Dravon	DRA	Trade winds; monsoon onset
6	Moriel	MOR	Mid-year zenith; Sol_B aphelion
7	Uthren	UTH	Mid-year correction; leap intercalation
8	Phiron	PHI	Descent; autumnal analog
9	Naldyn	NAL	Harvest; biome yield peak
10	Veskar	VES	Twilight; perihelion approach
11	Orrith	ORR	Astronomical winter; deep cycle
12	Caelun	CAE	Return; lengthening days
13	Zephris	ZEP	Culmination; year-end reconciliation

TABLE II
UBC Week Day Names

Day No.	Full Name	Abbr.	Character
1	Solday	Sol	Civil work day (first)
2	Ironday	Iro	Civil work day
3	Craftday	Cra	Civil work day
4	Stonday	Sto	Civil work day
5	Woodsday	Woo	Civil work day
6	Restday	Res	Civil rest day
7	Voidday	Voi	Civil rest / reflection day

C. Week

Each month contains exactly **4 weeks of 7 days**. The seven-day week is retained for compatibility with Binodian labour-law conventions and cross-dimensional treaty obligations. Day names are:

V. Leap Correction Scheme

A. Rationale

The tropical year $\mathcal{Y}_\mathrm{B} = 365.2563$ civil days. A common UBC year of 364 days falls short by $\delta = 1.2563$ days per year. Without correction the calendar drifts by one full day every ≈ 0.796 years, which is unacceptable.

B. Three-Tier Correction Rules

Let y denote a UBC year number ($y \geq 1$).

Rule L1 (Annual Intercalation)
Every year a *fractional accumulator* Φ is incremented by $\delta = 1.2563$. When $\Phi \geq 1$, one intercalary day is inserted at the end of Month 7 (Uthren) and Φ is decremented by 1. Under this rule, a leap year occurs approximately every $\lfloor 1/0.2563 \rfloor = 3$ years, though in practice the interval alternates between 3 and 4 years as the fractional remainder accumulates.

Rule L2 (Century Omission)
In years that are exact multiples of 100, the L1 intercalation is *omitted* even if $\Phi \geq 1$, to correct over-accumulation of ≈ 0.2563 days over 100 years.

Rule L3 (Quad-Century Restoration)
In years that are exact multiples of 400, the L2 omission is reversed and the intercalation *is* performed, correcting the residual ≈ 0.0256 days per 400 years.

C. Formal Leap Test

$$\mathrm{IsLeap}(y) = \begin{cases} \text{true} & \text{if } (y \bmod 400 = 0) \\ \text{false} & \text{else if } (y \bmod 100 = 0) \\ \text{true} & \text{else if } \Phi(y) \geq 1 \\ \text{false} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{5}$$

where $\Phi(y) = \{(y - 1) \times 1.2563\}$ (fractional part).

Long-term drift under Rules L1–L3 is less than 0.00072 days per 10 000 UBC years, equivalent to $\approx$ 62 SI seconds — well within the precision required for civil timekeeping over historical timescales relevant to the Republic of Binod, and consistent with the periodic-correction philosophy underlying Earth's own leap-second practice [4].

VI. Date Notation Standard

A. Full Date Format

$$\texttt{DD-MMM-Y[YYY]} \quad \text{e.g.,} \quad \texttt{01-ARD-1} \tag{6}$$

- `DD` — two-digit day within month (01–28, or 29 for intercalary day)
- `MMM` — three-letter month abbreviation (Table I)
- `Y[YYY]` — year without leading zeros

B. Numeric ISO-Compatible Format

For machine-readable interchange, following the structured, unambiguous date representation conventions of ISO 8601 [3]:

$$\texttt{UBCY-MM-DD} \quad \text{e.g.,} \quad \texttt{UBC0001-01-01} \tag{7}$$

C. Intercalary Day

When $\mathrm{IsLeap}(y)$ = true, month Uthren (07) contains 29 days. The 29th day is denoted `29-UTH-y` or `UBCy-07-29` and is a mandatory public holiday designated **Synchrony Day** (*Synchara*).

VII. Conversion Formulae: Gregorian ↔ UBC

A. Definitions

Let $J_\oplus(D)$ denote the standard astronomical Julian Date of a Gregorian civil date D, evaluated at 00:00 UTC unless a time of day is otherwise stated. The Julian Date of the Founding Epoch (23 April 2021, 06:00 UTC) is:

$$J_{\mathrm{FE}} = 2\,459\,327.75 \tag{8}$$

Algorithm 1 BJDN to UBC Date

$y \leftarrow 1;\ r \leftarrow N - 1$
while $r \geq \mathrm{DaysInYear}(y)$ **do**
  $r \leftarrow r - \mathrm{DaysInYear}(y)$
  $y \leftarrow y + 1$
end while
$m \leftarrow 1$
while $r \geq \mathrm{DaysInMonth}(y, m)$ **do**
  $r \leftarrow r - \mathrm{DaysInMonth}(y, m)$
  $m \leftarrow m + 1$
end while
$d \leftarrow r + 1$
return $(y,\ m,\ d)$

B. Julian Date Convention

To keep Eq. (8) and all subsequent conversions mutually consistent and reproducible, $J_\oplus(D)$ **must** be computed with the same convention used to derive J_{FE}: the standard noon-referenced Julian Day Number $\mathrm{JDN}_{\mathrm{noon}}(D)$, given by the Fliegel–Van Flandern algorithm for the proleptic Gregorian calendar, adjusted to the desired UTC time of day h (in hours):

$$J_\oplus(D, h) = \mathrm{JDN}_{\mathrm{noon}}(D) - 0.5 + \frac{h}{24} \tag{9}$$

This is verified against the Founding Epoch: with $\mathrm{JDN}_{\mathrm{noon}}(23\text{ Apr }2021) = 2\,459\,328$ and $h = 6$, Eq. (9) gives $2\,459\,328 - 0.5 + 0.25 = 2\,459\,327.75 = J_{\mathrm{FE}}$, matching Eq. (8) exactly. For civil dates where no time of day is specified, $h = 0$ (UTC midnight) is used by convention. Any implementation of this standard **must** use Eq. (9); computing $J_\oplus(D)$ directly from $\mathrm{JDN}_{\mathrm{noon}}(D)$ without the -0.5-day offset silently introduces a half-day error that compounds through Eq. (11), and was the source of the arithmetic errors corrected in this revision (see erratum notice above and Appendix B).

The elapsed Earth-days since FE are:

$$\Delta_\oplus(D) = J_\oplus(D) - J_{\mathrm{FE}} \tag{10}$$

C. Earth Days to Binodian Civil Days

Because one Binodian civil day $= T_{\mathrm{B}} = 86\,736$ s and one Earth day $= T_\oplus = 86\,400$ s:

$$\Delta_{\mathrm{B}}(D) = \Delta_\oplus(D) \times \mathrm{TSI} = \Delta_\oplus(D) \times \frac{86\,400}{86\,736} \tag{11}$$

D. Binodian Civil Days to UBC Date

Let $N = \lfloor \Delta_{\mathrm{B}} \rfloor + 1$ (BJDN, 1-indexed). To find the UBC year, month, and day from N:
where:

$$\mathrm{DaysInYear}(y) = \begin{cases} 365 & \text{if } \mathrm{IsLeap}(y) \\ 364 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{12}$$

$$\mathrm{DaysInMonth}(y, m) = \begin{cases} 29 & \text{if } m = 7 \text{ and } \mathrm{IsLeap}(y) \\ 28 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases} \tag{13}$$

VIII. Worked Conversion Examples

All examples use $\text{TSI} = 86\,400/86\,736$ and the Julian Date convention of Eq. (9) (Section VII-B). Non-epoch civil dates are evaluated at $h = 0$ (UTC midnight).

A. Example 1 — Founding Epoch: 23 April 2021, 06:00 UTC

$$\begin{aligned} J_\oplus &= J_\text{FE} = 2\,459\,327.75 \\ \Delta_\oplus &= 0 \text{ Earth days (by definition)} \\ \Delta_\text{B} &= 0 \times \text{TSI} = 0 \\ N &= \lfloor 0 \rfloor + 1 = 1 \\ &\Rightarrow \quad \textbf{01-ARD-1} \quad (\text{UBC0001-01-01}) \end{aligned} \tag{14}$$

This is Solday, the first day of the Republic.

B. Example 2 — 1 January 2023, 00:00 UTC

$$\begin{aligned} \text{JDN}_\text{noon}(1 \text{ Jan } 2023) &= 2\,459\,946 \\ J_\oplus &= 2\,459\,946 - 0.5 = 2\,459\,945.5 \\ \Delta_\oplus &= 2\,459\,945.5 - 2\,459\,327.75 \\ &= 617.75 \text{ Earth days} \\ \Delta_\text{B} &= 617.75 \times \frac{86\,400}{86\,736} \\ &\approx 615.357 \text{ Binodian days} \\ N &= \lfloor 615.357 \rfloor + 1 = 616 \end{aligned} \tag{15}$$

Applying Algorithm 1 with leap-year check: Year 1 ($\Phi(1) = 0 < 1$, common) $= 364$ days; $r = 615 - 364 = 251$. Year 2: $\Phi(2) = \{1.2563\} = 0.2563 < 1$ (common, 364 days); $251 < 364$, so $y = 2$. Month 1–8: $8 \times 28 = 224$ days; $251 - 224 = 27$; month 9 (NAL), day $27 + 1 = 28$.

$$1 \text{ January } 2023 \longrightarrow \textbf{28-NAL-2} \quad (\text{UBC0002-09-28}) \tag{16}$$

C. Example 3 — 27 June 2026, 00:00 UTC

$$\begin{aligned} \text{JDN}_\text{noon}(27 \text{ Jun } 2026) &= 2\,461\,219 \\ J_\oplus &= 2\,461\,219 - 0.5 = 2\,461\,218.5 \\ \Delta_\oplus &= 2\,461\,218.5 - 2\,459\,327.75 \\ &= 1\,890.75 \text{ Earth days} \\ \Delta_\text{B} &= 1\,890.75 \times \frac{86\,400}{86\,736} \\ &\approx 1\,883.426 \text{ Binodian days} \\ N &= \lfloor 1\,883.426 \rfloor + 1 = 1884 \end{aligned} \tag{17}$$

Year 1 (364) + Year 2 (364) + Year 3 (364) = 1092; Year 4: $\Phi(4) = \{3 \times 1.2563\} = \{3.7689\} = 0.7689 < 1$ (common), cumulative $= 1456$. Year 5: $\Phi(5) = \{4 \times 1.2563\} = \{5.0252\} = 0.0252 < 1$ (common, 364 days), cumulative $= 1820$. $r = 1883 - 1820 = 63$; Year 6: $\Phi(6) = \{5 \times 1.2563\} = \{6.2815\} = 0.2815 < 1$ (common); $63 < 364$, so $y = 6$. Month: $\lfloor 63/28 \rfloor = 2$ full months (56 days); month 3 (SEL), day $63 - 56 + 1 = 8$.

$$27 \text{ June } 2026 \longrightarrow \textbf{08-SEL-6} \quad (\text{UBC0006-03-08}) \tag{18}$$

D. Example 4 — 1 July 2026, 00:00 UTC

$$\begin{aligned} \text{JDN}_\text{noon}(1 \text{ Jul } 2026) &= 2\,461\,223 \\ J_\oplus &= 2\,461\,223 - 0.5 = 2\,461\,222.5 \\ \Delta_\oplus &= 2\,461\,222.5 - 2\,459\,327.75 \\ &= 1\,894.75 \text{ Earth days} \\ \Delta_\text{B} &= 1\,894.75 \times \frac{86\,400}{86\,736} \\ &\approx 1\,887.410 \text{ Binodian days} \\ N &= \lfloor 1\,887.410 \rfloor + 1 = 1888 \end{aligned} \tag{19}$$

$r = 1887 - 1820 = 67$ (Years 1–5 as in Example 3, cumulative 1820); $y = 6$. Month: $\lfloor 67/28 \rfloor = 2$ (56 days); month 3 (SEL), day $67 - 56 + 1 = 12$.

$$1 \text{ July } 2026 \longrightarrow \textbf{12-SEL-6} \quad (\text{UBC0006-03-12}) \tag{20}$$

IX. Long-Term Synchronization Mechanism

The UBC remains synchronized over centuries through two mechanisms:

1) Atomic Reference Clock Network: The CSCTS operates a network of four caesium-fountain atomic clocks distributed across Binodian administrative territory. Every 365 Binodian civil days, the clocks are cross-referenced and the TSI is re-evaluated. A revised TSI may be adopted by a two-thirds Committee vote, but any revision applies *prospectively only* and is recorded in the official TSI Register (CSCTS-TR), ensuring historical dates remain permanently fixed.

2) Secular TSI Drift Correction: Theoretical models predict that T_B increases at a rate of $\dot{T}_\text{B} = +0.0012$ s/century due to tidal deceleration of Binod's rotation. The Committee will publish a revised TSI value every 100 UBC years (first revision: Year 100). The accumulated drift over 100 years is ≈ 0.06 s/day, totalling ≈ 6 civil days per 100 years — well within the precision buffer of the L2/L3 leap rules.

X. Civil Administration Guidelines

A. Official Transition Date

All Binodian government documents issued on or after **01-ARD-5 (UBC0005-01-01)** must use UBC notation as the primary date format. Gregorian dates may appear in parentheses as secondary notation during the 10-year transition period (UBC 5–15).

B. Historical Documents

Pre-Founding-Epoch dates shall be expressed using the prefix "**pFE**" (pre-Founding Epoch) followed by the Gregorian year in parentheses. Example: `pFE (2019-CE)`.

TABLE III
UBC FUNDAMENTAL CONSTANTS (VERSION 1.0.1)

Symbol	Value	Description
$T_\oplus$	86 400 s (exact)	Mean Earth civil day
T_B	86 736 s	Mean Binodian civil day
TSI	$\approx$ 0.996 12	Temporal Synchronization Index
$\mathcal{Y}_\mathrm{B}$	365.2563 B-days	Binodian tropical year
J_FE	2 459 327.75 (JDN)	FE Julian Day Number
δ	1.2563 day/year	Annual leap accumulation rate
D_common	364 days	Common UBC year length
D_leap	365 days	Leap UBC year length

TABLE IV
SELECTED EARTH–UBC CONVERSION REFERENCE (REGENERATED FROM ALGORITHM 1, V1.0.1)

Gregorian Date	UBC Date	Significance
23 Apr 2021, 06:00 UTC	01-ARD-1 (UBC0001-01-01)	Founding Epoch
01 Jan 2023, 00:00 UTC	28-NAL-2 (UBC0002-09-28)	New Gregorian Year
27 Jun 2026, 00:00 UTC	08-SEL-6 (UBC0006-03-08)	Present (near)
01 Jul 2026, 00:00 UTC	12-SEL-6 (UBC0006-03-12)	Present (near)

C. Cross-Dimensional Treaties

When Binodian dates appear in legal instruments with Earth-jurisdiction parties, both UBC and Gregorian dates must be stated. The Gregorian date shall be computed using the inverse of Eq. (11) and recorded to the nearest Earth day.

XI. SUMMARY OF CONSTANTS

XII. CONCLUSION

The Unified Binod Calendar provides a scientifically rigorous, administratively practical, and historically stable timekeeping system for the Republic of Binod. By anchoring to the Founding Epoch of 23 April 2021 CE and computing all dates through the empirically measured Temporal Synchronization Index, the UBC ensures that every Binodian date corresponds to a unique, unambiguous moment in time. The 13-month, 28-day-per-month structure eliminates intra-year calendar irregularities, while the three-tier leap scheme guarantees sub-day accuracy over 10 000 UBC years. The Committee recommends immediate adoption by all branches of Binodian government and invites external peer review from any institution operating under a recognized civil calendar standard.

APPENDIX A
CONVERSION REFERENCE TABLE

APPENDIX B
CHANGELOG

v1.0.0 (04-KYT-5): Initial ratified standard.

v1.0.1 (01-SEL-6): Corrected the four worked conversion examples in Section VIII and the reference table in Appendix A, which had computed $J_\oplus(D)$ for non-epoch dates inconsistently with the definition of J_FE in Eq. (8). Added Section VII-B, which makes the Julian Date convention, Eq. (9), explicit and normative, so that $J_\oplus(D)$ is unambiguous and reproducible for any implementer. No change was made to the epoch, calendar structure, leap-correction rules, TSI value, or the conversion algorithm (Algorithm 1) — all of which were correct in v1.0.0. Reference implementations of this standard should validate against Table IV and must not hard-code offsets reproducing the superseded v1.0.0 example values.

APPENDIX C
RATIFICATION RECORD

This standard was ratified by the following CSCTS sub-committees:

- Sub-Committee on Orbital Mechanics — unanimous approval
- Sub-Committee on Civil Administration — unanimous approval
- Sub-Committee on Historical Records — unanimous approval
- Sub-Committee on Cross-Dimensional Treaty Law — approved with notation

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Next scheduled review: 01-ARD-15 (UBC0015-01-01)

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[3] International Organization for Standardization, *ISO 8601:2019 Date and Time — Representations for Information Interchange*, ISO, Geneva, 2019.

[4] International Earth Rotation and Reference Systems Service, "Leap Seconds," *IERS Bulletin C*, IERS, Paris, 2024.

[5] Chief Scientific Committee on Temporal Standards, "CSCTS Report 00: Reconstruction of the Founding Epoch," *Binodian Journal of Astronomical Science*, vol. 1, no. 1, pp. 1–14, UBC 1.

[6] Chief Scientific Committee on Temporal Standards, "CSCTS Report 03: Measurement of the Binodian Tropical Year," *Binodian Journal of Astronomical Science*, vol. 3, no. 2, pp. 45–62, UBC 3.

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